CHINA HEALTHCARE

Takeaways from our 47th Global Healthcare Conference and investor feedback from US marketing

We participated in the 47th Global Healthcare Conference (June 8-10) and met with 30+ investors across Miami, New York, and Boston.

Positioning remained cautious, reflecting a sharp YTD underperformance in China healthcare (avg of -11% YTD, vs +42% in 2025 for our coverage), and our view of a continued disconnect between share price and underlying fundamentals (robust clinical data readouts and sustained BD activities). In addition to ongoing sector rotation toward AI/semiconductors, investors highlighted **policy overhangs**—including evolving China/US regulatory uncertainty around BD and domestic anti-corruption-related earnings risks—as key drivers of weak positioning. Among investors who remain constructive on **CDMOs**, conviction continues to be anchored in structural competitiveness and the sector has **demonstrated resilience** through the past two years of geopolitical uncertainty, with limited fundamental disruption, supported by diversified global demand, strong execution, and leading cost/technology positioning.

That said, **the recent pullback is prompting reassessment.** Investors remain constructive on the growing strategic role of China innovation in global drug development, with multiple MNCs **large-cap pharma reiterating the structural importance of China within their pipeline in our conference. Focus has increasingly shifted toward** near-term catalysts to help close the gap between fundamentals and valuations, including upcoming clinical data, BD/licensing announcements, and 2Q earnings. We also observe rising interest in IPO pipelines with strong aftermarket performance (see China strategist's report on HK IPO), alongside a pickup in corporates' share buybacks across the sector post-correction.

Our view: while near-term sentiment remains subdued, we believe the **risk-reward is skewing more favorably into 2H**, as fundamentals remain intact and catalysts visibility improves. We continue to see structural opportunity in China biotech BD and view the recent correction as an attractive point to build positions for companies with **clear earnings' visibility, validated assets, and ongoing commercialization progress**. Key Buy-rated stocks going into 2H include, **CDMO:** WuXi AppTec, Samsung Bio, Asymchem, XDC; **Biotech/Pharma:** Kelun Biotech, BeOne, Innovent, Hansoh**; Medtech:** Medbot, Edge, AngelAlign.

Upcoming events: *China Healthcare Corporate Day, Jun 24-26 (HK); Asia Healthcare*

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CDMO Day, Sep 23-25 (Singapore)

Key themes and debates with our investor discussion

Biotech/ Pharma: China innovation rising, global strategic relevance strengthens, amid geopolitics discussion

- **China innovation moved further into the global strategic agenda:** The conference reinforced that global biopharma companies are increasingly recognizing China as a meaningful source of innovation and clinical development leverage. China was repeatedly discussed alongside AI as a strategic theme, with large pharma acknowledging that China-originated assets have improved materially in quality and depth over the past several years. Notably, Gilead highlighted that roughly half of its prioritized corporate development opportunities either originating from China or linked to China-originated innovation. More strategically, Pfizer framed China companies as reliant today on US/EU pharma for global trials and commercialization, but may potentially be capable of building those capabilities by around 2030, which is in accordance with the strategic planning of some China biopharma (e.g. Innovent targeted to build global end-to-end capabilities across global markets in their Vision 2030).
- **Out-licensing remains the clearest go-global route, despite geopolitics discussions:** Discussions around China out-licensing remain constructive but more nuanced: 1) Large-cap biopharma continued to emphasize M&A and BD as key strategic levers, which we view as continued supportive for China out-licensing, particularly in areas where China has built visible clinical and platform depth (e.g. oncology, ADCs, bispecifics/TCEs). We see the conference tone as validating that global pharma demand for China-originated innovation remains intact, but with increasing preference for assets that can fit cleanly into global development strategies and partner portfolios; 2) Recent news flow (here and here) regarding potentially higher bi-lateral regulatory scrutiny on China out-licensing stimulated discussions on the geopolitical and policy uncertainty. Based on our communications, the discussions tended to focus more on China regulation (vs. US side) given the lower policy visibility, and most investors agreed that structural change is unlikely if China regulatory scrutiny were to focus more on platform out-licensing (rather than on single assets), while the near-term out-licensing trend will be the top focus to monitor potential headwinds.
- **China data translatability remains an active area of investor focus, with PD-1/VEGF and ADCs among the key topics:** Our conversations highlighted continued discussions around whether China-generated clinical data can support global development and regulatory decision-making. The SMMT/Akeso ivonescimab HARMONi-6 discussion was a focal point, with investor questions focused on global translatability, age subgroup imbalances, baseline characteristics, and the extent to which PFS translates into OS. Beyond PD-1/VEGF, ADC discussions around sac-TMT and other China-originated programs also suggested that investors are increasingly assessing translatability at the asset/trial level rather than applying a broad discount to all China data, as the quality of China trials become more widely recognized. Assets with more globally-relevant clinical development strategies (e.g. randomized

design with global SoC as control, well-balanced patient populations, global-standard endpoints, biomarker clarify, early FDA/EMA alignment) are likely to be viewed as more translatable, per our conversations. For China companies, this suggests that clinical development strategy is becoming as important as biology in determining BD probability and global valuation.

- **Investment takeaway:** We expect the next stage of the China innovation trade to be driven less by broad sector re-rating and more by company-specific proof points: credible global data packages, successful out-licensing execution, and evidence of regulatory translatability (see report here). In our view, companies with high-quality global assets, clear BD optionality, and disciplined trial design should continue to command a premium, while crowded mechanisms or less translatable datasets may see widening valuation dispersion. We prefer **Kelun Biotech** (de-risked sac-TMT with bar-setting data in NSCLC, MRK as committed global partner with 17 global ph3 trials), **BeOne Medicines** (validated clinical development “superhighway” to drive quick solid tumor build-up), and **Innovent** (strong pipeline delivery with increased visibility to deliver 5 assets at ph3 MRCT by 2030).

CDMO: showing resilience, strong execution underpins re-rating potential in 2H

- Positioning remains mixed but improving, with a growing group of investors re-engaging on the back of resilient fundamentals. While some US investors remain cautious given lingering headline and policy risks, constructive investors continue to build exposure, supported by limited fundamental disruption, strong technology and capacity advantages, and valuations that remain at a meaningful discount to global peers. At the company level, focus has increasingly shifted toward execution and earnings visibility as key re-rating drivers.
- For **WuXi AppTec**, while inclusion on the US’s 1260H list has led to some short-term share price volatility and the company has filed a complaint to challenge the designation, investor attention has shifted toward underlying growth drivers and sustainability of multi-quarter delivery. We highlight diversified growth beyond peptide GLP-1, supported by strong order momentum with potential 2Q guidance upside seen as a key catalyst; **WuXi Biologics**’ royalty-based income is seen as supportive to mid-term earnings, albeit with lower modeling visibility; **WuXi XDC’s** order momentum remains robust and valuations are increasingly viewed as attractive, though investors are watching for incremental commercial traction at the Singapore site; Mgmt emphasized on the BioDlink integration that it will secure immediate operating capacity and customer network, and that they see the Singapore site as a large-scale commercial manufacturing site for long term growth.
- **Asymchem** continues to draw attention on its GLP-1-related capacity expansion, investor debate has increasingly centered on margin trajectory and utilization ramp of expanded peptide capacity. We remain constructive on emerging platform expansion (peptides/ADC/oligos) supporting both growth and margin, with focus on commercial mix and GLP-1 visibility; For **Tigermed**, sentiment remains cautious, reflecting recent earnings miss, pricing pressure, and AI investment drag, alongside regulatory uncertainty (CSRC investigation). However, we see early signs of demand recovery with improving order intake, and note that the outcome of the CSRC

investigation could serve as a clear event for share price recovery; **Samsung Biologics:** discussions were focused on near-term volatility from labor negotiations and quarterly order timing, though we emphasize strong structural fundamentals (high utilization, global client base, capacity expansion optionality) with key catalysts including labor resolution, order inflow, and Plant 6 capex clarity. See our previous NDR takeaway note.

MedTech & Services: selective interest; go-global remains key differentiator

- Investor engagement remains relatively muted, with positioning turning more selective. Interest is concentrated in names with **clear idiosyncratic drivers and demonstrated overseas execution**, while broader sentiment is constrained by **soft domestic in-hospital demand, tightening reimbursement, and anti-corruption impact on near-term activity**. Investors are increasingly focused on whether domestic volume trends are bottoming (See our China Pharma team's bidding tracker) and whether international expansion can drive **sustainable growth and margin scalability**.
- For **AngelAlign**, investor focus has shifted toward overseas execution quality, margin trajectory, and pricing discipline, with improved confidence following clear case volume guidance and earlier-than-expected overseas breakeven, while visibility on VBP timing remains limited. Angelalign's overseas expansion over the past two years has continued to track ahead of expectations, driven not merely by pricing competition, but also by product capability, digital design efficiency and brand recognition. During our conference, **Align Technology (ALGN)** emphasized its focus on untapped growth opportunities rather than competitive dynamics, highlighting the significant potential in underpenetrated segments. Management pointed in particular to expansion within the GP channel and broader patient base, supported by ongoing technology innovation (including AI and 3D printing). They also underscored a more diversified product portfolio, enabling differentiated pricing strategies (e.g., lower-cost and zero-refinement offerings) to drive penetration across distinct customer segments.
- In **surgical robotics**, overseas investors are increasingly prioritizing differentiated technology and clinical value over pure pricing competitiveness. Continued disclosure of overseas orders is seen as critical to validating global competitiveness and supporting valuation re-rating, **Medbot**'s Toumai laparoscopic surgical robot, has received over 300 commercial orders worldwide (c. 240+ from overseas, vs c.170 as of Mar 2026), and we see order disclosure helps address visibility concerns and reinforces the overseas execution thesis. In our discussions since our surgical robot initiation, investors broadly recognize the structural opportunity and platform economics, and early overseas traction has also helped anchor the story while awaiting more near-term earnings visibility to support the high valuation multiples.

Read-across from global conference – sentiment subdued, but positioning selective; China remains structurally relevant

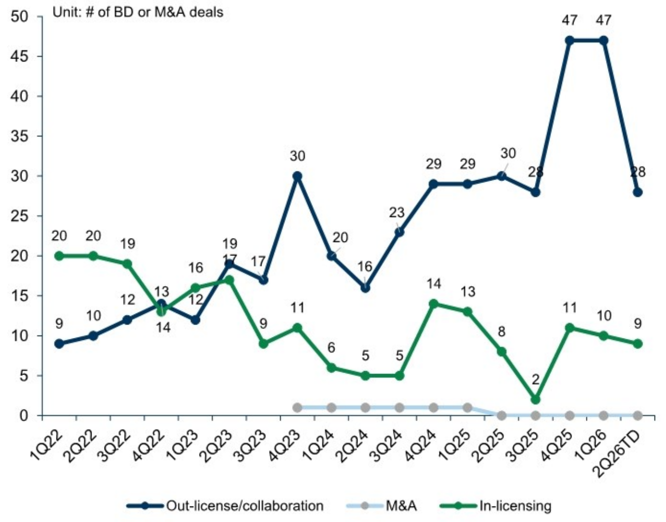
- At a high level, **US healthcare sentiment remains cautious**, per the panel discussion with our US strategist and healthcare sales specialists during the conference, with the sector continuing to exhibit one of the highest levels of short interest. Correlation with AI has turned negative in recent years, and investor engagement remains largely **event- and macro-dependent**, driven by earnings' delivery, visibility of investable narratives, and the outlook for US rate cuts. Our economists expect no Fed rate cuts in 2026 and two cuts (June and December) in 2027, while some investors are pricing in rate hike risk, adding to near-term uncertainty. Survey data (report here) suggest **mixed but low-conviction positioning**: while 43% of respondents expect healthcare to outperform the S&P 500 in 2H26, low participation confirms broader apathy and a lack of conviction in the healthcare sector, in our view. Within subsectors, sentiment is **constructive on biotech but cautious on hospitals**, reinforcing the selective nature of current fund flows.

- Despite near-term nuances/caveats on the BD related proposal, **global large-cap pharma remains constructive on China's strategic importance**, particularly as a source of innovation and early-stage assets. Pfizer highlighted that while Chinese biotechs still rely on global pharma for late-stage development and commercialization today, capability gaps are expected to narrow over time (~by 2030), with competition increasingly defined by speed, cost, and AI integration. **AstraZeneca** similarly sees continued collaboration opportunities, albeit with rising competitive intensity from local innovation. **Gilead** emphasized China's growing role as both an innovation engine and early clinical development hub, noting that ~50% of its corporate development opportunities are now sourced from or linked to China, reflecting the rapid improvement in asset quality and depth. **Novartis** also reiterated openness to expanding its presence in China through M&A, particularly in next-generation modalities (e.g., radioligand therapy, cell therapy, multispecifics), further reinforcing China's positioning within global pharma innovation pipelines. (See also the US team's takeaway wrap up.)

- **AI in healthcare – focus on efficiency and long-term revenue upside; monetization still early:** AI remains a key strategic focus across healthcare, with current applications primarily centered on driving operational efficiency and improving R&D productivity, rather than direct revenue generation. Large-cap pharma (e.g., Pfizer) highlighted that AI is already contributing to meaningful cost savings without impacting top-line growth, supporting earnings delivery, with the next phase of deployment expected to shift toward **revenue generation opportunities as scale increases into 2H26**. Across subsectors, **use cases remain fragmented but increasingly embedded**: in pharma/tools, AI is being applied across **drug discovery, in-silico design, and clinical workflows**, often requiring tight integration between computational models and experimental validation; in MedTech and services, AI is focused on **enhancing clinical workflows, care delivery, and operational efficiency**; while in HCIT, companies are beginning to see both **revenue and cost benefits**. Importantly, management teams broadly frame AI as a **complementary tool rather than a disruptive replacement**, enhancing productivity across the multi-step development process rather than displacing existing infrastructure. Our discussion with investors on AI disruption was relatively limited, with focus shifting toward understanding the capabilities and commercial positioning of AI drug discovery companies and investors are looking for clearer data validation and proof of value creation before increasing exposure.

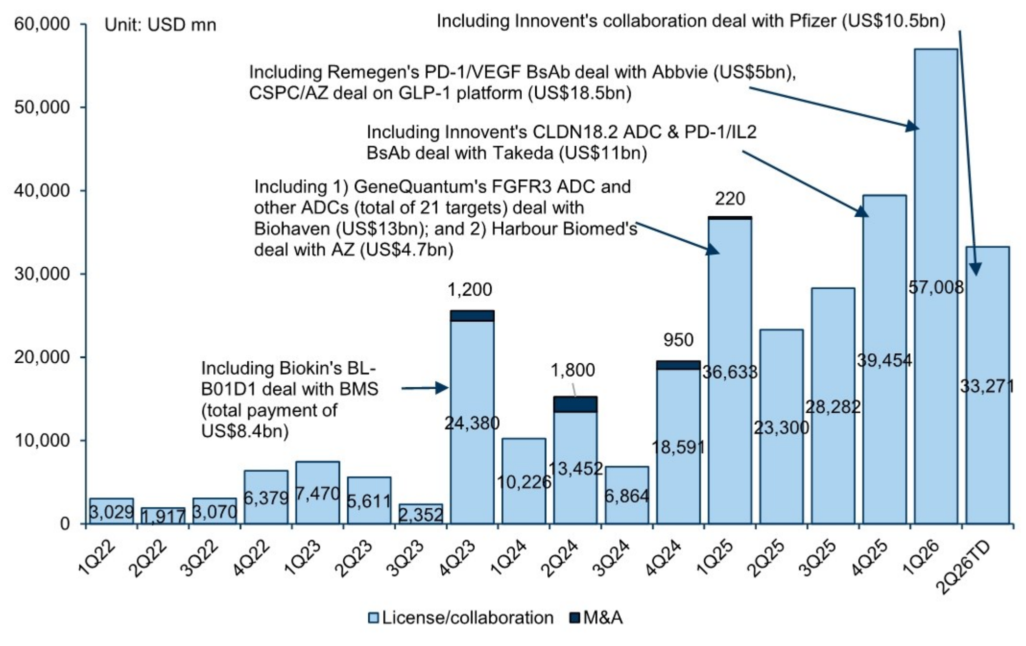
China-sourced BD activities remain active YTD 2026

Exhibit 1: China-sourced BD deals surged to over 50 each quarter since 4Q25
Number of in-license/out-license BD and M&A for China Biotech



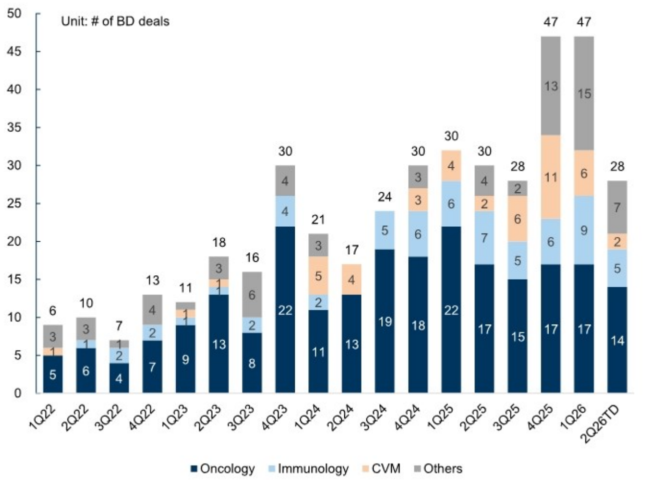
Source: PharmCube, data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Total deal sizes continue upward trend
Total deal value of out-license BD and company acquisition activities for China Biotech (FY2022-26)



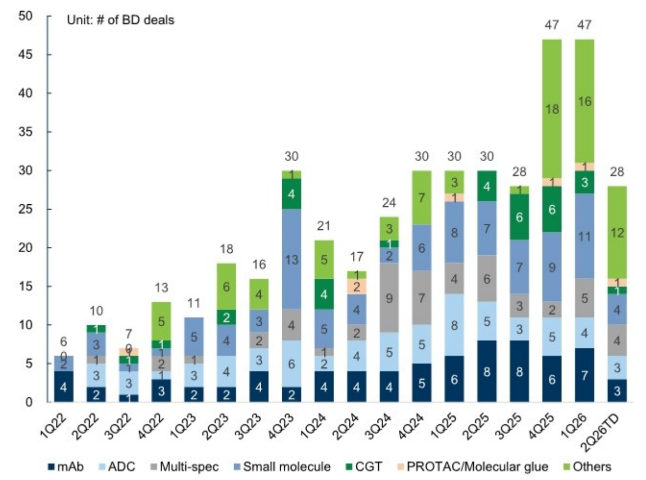
Source: PharmCube, data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Therapeutic areas are diversifying in China out-license deals...
Number of out-license BD deals for China Pharma/Biotech (FY2022—2026YTD), by therapeutic areas



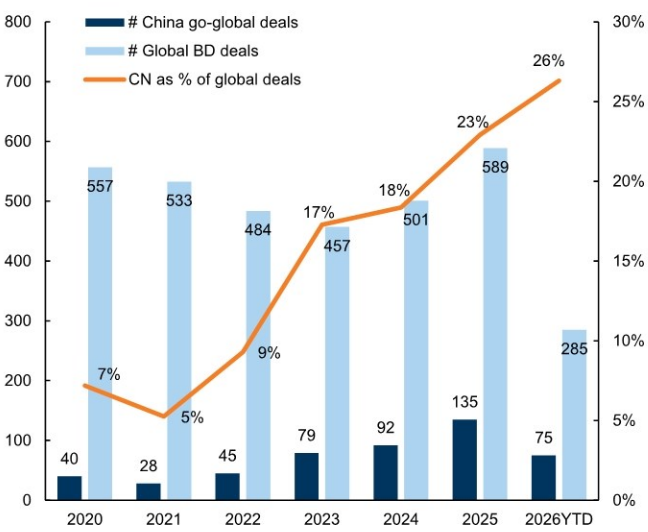
Source: PharmCube, data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: ...as well as in modalities where China has built visible clinical and platform depth
Number of out-license BD deals for China Pharma/Biotech (FY2022—2026YTD), by modality



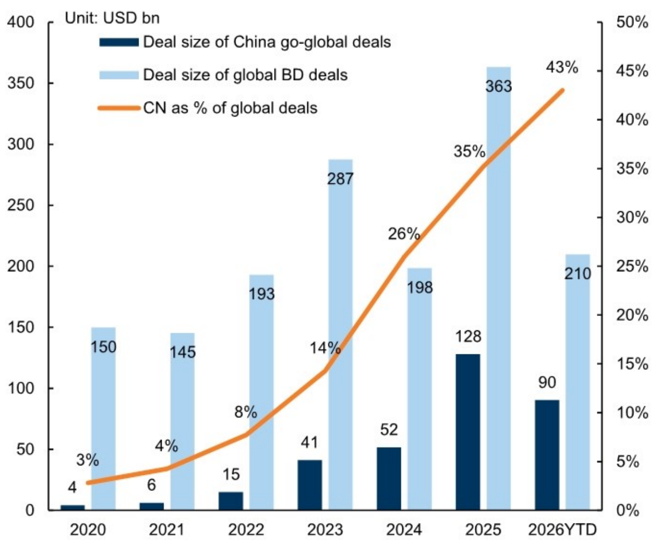
Source: PharmCube, data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Number of China out-license BD deals has reached about a quarter of total number of deals globally
China go-global as % of global BD deals



Source: PharmCube, data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: China out-license BD deals have gained a significant proportion of total global deal size
China go-global deal size as % of global BD deal size



Source: PharmCube, data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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